pirzada	An official at a Sufi shrine, often a descendant of the founding saint.
pishkhidmat	The personal servant of a sardar or king.
pustin	An Afghan sheepskin coat (from ‘post’, Dari for skin).
qalandar	A Sufi mendicant or holy fool.
Qizilbash	Literally ‘redheads’, a name given to Safavid soldiers (and later traders), owing to the tall red cap worn under their turbans. These Shia colonists first came to Afghanistan from Persia with the armies of Nadir Shah and later acted as the royal guard of the Durranis. By the 1830s they formed their own distinct community with their own quarters, the Chindawol and Murad Khani, and their own leaders, and their loyalties had to be bought by any potential claimant to the throne.
rahdari	The levy paid to the mountain tribes to keep the road safe and protect the armies and traders travelling along it.
rundi	A dancing girl or prostitute. It has been suggested that this Hindi word could be the root of the English word ‘randy’.
sangar	A shallow trench protected by a low mud wall, or breastworks, traditionally built by Afghan fighters to protect jezail snipers.
sardar	A chief, commander or nobleman. Among the Sadozais, it was the military title held by the head of the Durrani clans and the title held by all members of the royal family. Among Sikhs the title was given to all followers of Khalsa, and the word survives in daily use in modern India as a respectful way to address any Sikh.
sawar	A cavalryman. At this period also spelt ‘suwar’ or ‘sowar’.
sepoy	An Indian soldier in the service of the East India Company.
sayyed (f. sayyida)	A lineal descendant of the Prophet Mohammad. Sayyeds often have the title ‘Mir’.
shahzada	A prince.
shamiana	An Indian marquee, or the screen formed around the perimeter of a tented area.
Shia	One of the two principal divisions of Islam, dating back to a split that occurred